

INTERNATIONAL AS PSYCHOLOGY

PS01

Unit 1 Introductory Topics in Psychology

Mark scheme

January 2025

Version: 1.0 Final



Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

Further copies of this mark scheme are available from www.oxfordaqa.com

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Level of response marking instructions

Level of response mark schemes are broken down into levels, each of which has a descriptor. The descriptor for the level shows the average performance for the level. There are marks in each level.

Before you apply the mark scheme to a student's answer read through the answer and annotate it (as instructed) to show the qualities that are being looked for. You can then apply the mark scheme.

Step 1 Determine a level

Start at the lowest level of the mark scheme and use it as a ladder to see whether the answer meets the descriptor for that level. The descriptor for the level indicates the different qualities that might be seen in the student's answer for that level. If it meets the lowest level then go to the next one and decide if it meets this level, and so on, until you have a match between the level descriptor and the answer. With practice and familiarity you will find that for better answers you will be able to quickly skip through the lower levels of the mark scheme.

When assigning a level you should look at the overall quality of the answer and not look to pick holes in small and specific parts of the answer where the student has not performed quite as well as the rest. If the answer covers different aspects of different levels of the mark scheme you should use a best fit approach for defining the level and then use the variability of the response to help decide the mark within the level, ie if the response is predominantly level 3 with a small amount of level 4 material it would be placed in level 3 but be awarded a mark near the top of the level because of the level 4 content.

Step 2 Determine a mark

Once you have assigned a level you need to decide on the mark. The descriptors on how to allocate marks can help with this. The exemplar materials used during standardisation will help. There will be an answer in the standardising materials which will correspond with each level of the mark scheme. This answer will have been awarded a mark by the Lead Examiner. You can compare the student's answer with the example to determine if it is the same standard, better or worse than the example. You can then use this to allocate a mark for the answer based on the Lead Examiner's mark on the example.

You may well need to read back through the answer as you apply the mark scheme to clarify points and assure yourself that the level and the mark are appropriate.

Indicative content in the mark scheme is provided as a guide for examiners. It is not intended to be exhaustive and you must credit other valid points. Students do not have to cover all of the points mentioned in the Indicative content to reach the highest level of the mark scheme.

An answer which contains nothing of relevance to the question must be awarded no marks.

Section A: Memory

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
01	Which statement about the cognitive interview is not true? Shade one box only. Answer key: A – The cognitive interview includes leading questions.	1 AO1 = 1

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
02	Outline the procedure of one study that investigated the duration of long-term memory. Award marks as follows: 3 marks: the outline of the procedure of one study that investigated the duration of long-term memory is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: the outline of the procedure of one study that investigated the duration of long-term memory lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: the outline of the procedure of one study that investigated the duration of long-term memory is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content 392 graduates of an American high school aged up to 75 years, participants were tested on memory of other students in their year group. Tests included recognition of pictures, matching names to pictures, recalling names with no picture cue (Bahrick et al (1975)). Credit description of other relevant studies, eg Bahrick & Hall (1991), Mitchell (2006), Larzabal et al (2018).	3 AO1 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
03	Explain one strength of research into long-term memory. Award marks as follows: 3 marks: the explanation of a strength of research into long-term memory is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: the explanation of a strength of research into long-term memory lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: the explanation of strength of research into long-term memory is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • High ecological validity in duration studies by using meaningful material, eg Bahrick et al (1975). • High levels of control in encoding studies, eg Baddeley (1966), and studies into types of LTM using brain scans, eg Tulving et al (1994). • Research that improves our understanding of the nature/duration/encoding of LTM has practical applications. It can assist in identifying and targeting therapy for LTM problems including types of dementia. • Credit use of evidence supporting the existence of different types of LTM. Credit other relevant material.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
04	Explain one limitation of research into long-term memory. Award marks as follows: 3 marks: the explanation of a limitation of research into long-term memory is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: the explanation of a limitation of research into long-term memory lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: the explanation of a limitation of research into long-term memory is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible content • Lack of control in duration studies, eg participants revisiting material more often than others in the gap between tests (Bahrick et al (1975)). • Lower levels of ecological validity, eg encoding studies using meaningless lists (Baddeley (1966)), types of LTM studies taking place during brain scans (Tulving et al (1994)). • Confounding variables, eg it is impossible to determine if reductions in recall of long-term memories is down to indefinite duration/a limitation on capacity, or if it is due to aging in the brain. • Practical difficulties when studying LTM, eg testing memory at the end of a person's life will have ethical problems. Credit other relevant material.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
05	Kai is in his room drawing and listening to music. His mum comes in and asks him about his day. Kai is not able to listen to the music and talk to his mum at the same time. However, he is able to carry on drawing while he talks to his mum. Describe and evaluate the working memory model. Refer to Kai's behaviour in your answer. Possible content • The Working Memory Model (WMM) is a model of short-term memory (STM). • It was developed in response to oversimplistic ideas of the multi-store model (MSM). • Central executive has overall control. It has limited/no capacity. Encoding is modality specific. Responsibility for control processes including goal setting, attention, error monitoring and correction, inhibiting irrelevant information, retrieving information from long term memory (LTM), and coordinating processing resources for the other components (sub-systems) of working memory. • Phonological loop deals with auditory information. Limited capacity (1.5 seconds), temporary storage system. Divided into the phonological store and the articulatory loop. • Visuo-spatial sketchpad deals with optical (visual) and dimensional and geographical (spatial) information. Limited capacity, temporary storage system. Divided into the visual cache and the inner scribe. • Episodic buffer is a general storage facility for holding, combining and sequencing information from the other components of working memory and LTM. • Description of supporting studies, eg dual task performance research. Possible application • When Kai is drawing he is using the visuo-spatial sketchpad. • When Kai is listening to music or talking to his mum he is using the phonological loop. • Kai has to turn off the music when he wants to talk to his mum because both activities would use the phonological loop which has limited capacity so he would be unable to complete both tasks at once. • Kai can continue to draw whilst talking to his mum because the tasks are using different stores and neither interferes with the other. Possible evaluation • Supporting evidence for existence of the different sub-systems, eg case studies, 'KF' Shallice and Warrington (1974), dual task performance studies, Baddeley & Hitch (1974), Klauer & Zhao (2004), Todd & Marois (2004), Baddeley & Wilson (2002). • Addresses weaknesses in the MSM by explaining that STM is not a single unitary store. • More thorough explanation of short term memory than the explanation of that store in the MSM as it suggests how memory functions with different	20 AO1 = 8 AO2 = 4 AO3 = 8

	components working together on different tasks, as opposed to simply describing the structure of memory (as in the MSM). • Can account for individual differences in memory processing, eg Turner & Engle (1989). • Practical application in terms of assessment for dyslexia, or recruitment for certain jobs. • Lack of clarity over the central executive due to difficulties in studying it. Credit other relevant material. Note: credit methodological issues as long as the link to the working memory model is clear. <table border="1" data-bbox="288 696 1318 1756"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>4</td><td>Knowledge of the working memory model is mostly accurate and generally well detailed. Evaluation is mostly effective. Application is appropriate. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.</td><td>16–20</td></tr> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Knowledge of the working memory model is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective evaluation/application. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.</td><td>11–15</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Limited knowledge of the working memory model is present. Any evaluation/application is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>6–10</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Knowledge of the working memory model is very limited. Evaluation/application is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–5</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	4	Knowledge of the working memory model is mostly accurate and generally well detailed. Evaluation is mostly effective. Application is appropriate. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	16–20	3	Knowledge of the working memory model is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective evaluation/application. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	11–15	2	Limited knowledge of the working memory model is present. Any evaluation/application is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	6–10	1	Knowledge of the working memory model is very limited. Evaluation/application is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–5	0	No creditable content.	0	
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Section B: Social Psychology

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
06	Name two types of conformity. Award 1 mark for each type of conformity, maximum two marks. Possible answers • Compliance. • Identification. • Internalisation.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
07	There are different explanations for why conformity occurs. Outline one explanation for conformity. Award marks as follows: 2 marks: for a clear outline of one explanation for conformity. 1 mark: for a muddled or vague outline of one explanation for conformity. Possible content: Normative influence • Based on the desire to be liked and accepted. • It is likely to occur because belonging is rewarding, and/or because groups can punish (exclude) those who don't fit in. • Individuals conform publicly but privately continue to disagree with the majority view (compliance). Informational influence • Based on the desire to do the right thing/be correct. • Most likely to occur in ambiguous situations (where the right thing to do is unclear). • Conformity is both public and private (internalisation). Credit other relevant material. Note: no marks for simply naming an explanation.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
08	Yara thinks that maths is difficult. The teacher writes some questions on the board. The other three students at Yara's table have worked out that the answer to the first question is six. Yara thinks that it is four. However, when the teacher asks Yara for her answer, she says "six". Use your knowledge of two variables that affect conformity to explain Yara's behaviour. For each variable, award marks as follows: 2 marks: for a clear application of a variable affecting conformity to explain Yara's behaviour. 1 mark: for a muddled or vague application of a variable affecting conformity to explain Yara's behaviour. Possible application • Yara finds maths difficult meaning she is more likely to conform to the behaviour of the other students at her table and change her answer to be the same as theirs. This shows the influence of task difficulty. • There are three other students at Yara's table, and a majority of three is the number of people required to increase the chance of conformity. This shows the influence of group size. • All of the students at Yara's table have arrived at the same answer of six, the majority all agree which makes it more likely that Yara will conform to their answer. This shows the influence of unanimity. Credit other relevant material. Credit responses presented in the converse eg Yara would have been less likely to conform if the majority had not been unanimous.	4 AO2 = 4

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
09	Describe legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience. Possible content • A legitimate authority is a person or organisation invested with social power. • Legitimate authority can be indicated by location and uniform. • Based on hierarchical structure of many societies with some members of the group having power over those beneath them. • Associated with social roles and social status. • We are socialised to recognise particular figures as legitimate authorities, and are taught from early childhood that we are more acceptable to society at large if we obey them. • We obey a legitimate authority because we trust them, or they have the power to punish, harm or exclude us. • When we obey a legitimate authority we expect them to take ultimate responsibility for the consequences of our actions. Credit other relevant material. Note: References to agentic state only creditworthy if clearly linked to being in this state as a result of the order from a legitimate authority. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Knowledge of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Knowledge of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Knowledge of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Knowledge of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO1 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	Knowledge of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks															
10	Evaluate legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience. Possible evaluation • Evidence supporting obedience to legitimate authority, eg Hofling et al (1966). • Evidence supporting role of location in indicating legitimacy of authority, eg Milgram variation moving from Yale to a down-town office. • Evidence supporting the role of uniform in indicating legitimate authority, eg Bickman (1974). • Real life applications, eg explaining war crimes. • Wider implications, eg justice system and potentially providing 'excuses' for criminality (diffusion of responsibility). • Methodological criticisms for supporting research into legitimacy of authority; lack of ecological validity, demand characteristics/internal validity. • Ethical criticisms (deception, protection from harm) make it difficult to replicate research to check reliability of findings. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1" data-bbox="300 974 1308 1657"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6	2	Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is relevant but detail/effectiveness is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	3–4	1	Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	6 AO3 = 6
Level	Description	Marks															
3	Evaluation of legitimacy of authority as an explanation for obedience is detailed and effective. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6															
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0	No creditable content.	0															

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks									
11	Describe and evaluate social support as an explanation for resisting social influence. Possible content • Social support is having the presence of other people (allies) who are defying the pressure to conform or obey (dissenting). • It makes us more likely to resist social influence. • Having support for their point of view can remove an individual's fear of being ridiculed, so avoiding effects of normative influence. • It can increase an individual's confidence that their position is correct allowing them to remain independent. • The dissenter does not need to give the correct answer, or the same one as the individual/participant for the effect to be observed. The dissenter is just modelling the behaviour of resistance. • Disobedient behaviour stands out less than if the individual acted alone, making disobedience more likely. • Description of relevant studies, eg variations of Asch & Milgram's investigations. Possible evaluation • Supporting evidence, eg Milgram (1963) disobedient confederate variation, Asch (1951), dissenting confederate variation, • Gamson, Fireman & Rytina (1982), rebellion against unjust authority, Allen & Levine (1971), dissenter with thick glasses. • Real world application; relevant to organisation of movements driving social change, understanding the mechanism can be important in management roles/teaching etc. • Comparison with other explanations, eg locus of control. • Methodological issues of research into social support, eg ecological issues, ethical considerations that might decrease validity of the explanation. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1" data-bbox="300 1503 1310 2045"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>4</td><td>Knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is mostly accurate and generally well detailed. Evaluation is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.</td><td>10–12</td></tr> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective evaluation. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.</td><td>7–9</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	4	Knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is mostly accurate and generally well detailed. Evaluation is mostly effective. Minor detail and/or expansion of argument is sometimes lacking. The answer is clear and focused. Specialist terminology is used effectively.	10–12	3	Knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is evident but there are occasional inaccuracies/omissions. There is some effective evaluation. The answer is mostly clear and organised but occasionally lacks focus. Specialist terminology is used appropriately.	7–9	12 AO1 = 6 AO3 = 6
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	2	Limited knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is present. Any evaluation is of limited effectiveness. The answer lacks clarity, accuracy and organisation in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately.	4–6	
	1	Knowledge of social support as an explanation for resisting social influence is very limited. Evaluation is limited, poorly focused or absent. The answer as a whole lacks clarity, has many inaccuracies and is poorly organised. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–3	
	0	No creditable content.	0	

Section C: Psychopathology

Total for this section: 30 marks

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
12	Deviation from ideal mental health is one definition of abnormality. Explain one limitation of deviation from ideal mental health as a definition of abnormality. Award marks as follows: 3 marks: the limitation of deviation from ideal mental health as a definition of abnormality is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: the limitation of deviation from ideal mental health as a definition of abnormality lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: the limitation of deviation from ideal mental health as a definition of abnormality is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible evaluation • It is culturally biased as it is based on western ideas, eg autonomy and potential for personal growth (self-actualisation) would not be viewed as features of ideal mental health in collectivist cultures. • It is not clear how much deviation is necessary to classify someone as abnormal according to this definition. This makes the definition difficult to use to classify abnormality. • It could seem unrealistic to expect someone to show resistance to stress, environmental mastery and personal autonomy (coping without support) all the time. • Judgements linked to the criteria are subjective. There is no diagnostic test to measure the aspects of mental health identified in this definition, so relies on self-reports, making the definition open to bias. Credit other relevant material.	3 AO3 = 3

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
13	Identify and describe two other definitions of abnormality For each definition, award marks as follows: 1 mark: for correctly identifying a definition of abnormality PLUS 2 marks: for a clear description of the identified definition of abnormality. 1 mark: for a muddled or vague description of the identified definition of abnormality. Possible content: Deviation from social norms • Behaviour that violates social rules of a society/culture is considered abnormal. • Social norms can be explicit or implicit. Failure to function adequately • A failure to cope with the demands of day-to-day life is abnormal. • Behaviours that can indicate this include observer discomfort, unpredictability, irrationality, maladaptiveness, personal suffering/distress. Statistical infrequency • Behaviour that deviates from the statistical average is abnormal (rare behaviours). • The less frequently a behaviour occurs the more likely it is to be abnormal, (more than 2 standard deviations from the mean). Credit use of relevant examples as part of description. Description marks can be awarded without naming the definition.	6 AO1 = 6

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
14	Name two characteristics of phobias. Award 1 mark for each characteristic. Possible content • Fear/Anxiety/Worry/Nervous/Scared. • Panic/Biological evidence of panic. • Irrational beliefs . • Selective attention. • Avoidance. Accept other relevant characteristics.	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
15	Outline the role of operant conditioning in maintaining a phobia. Award marks as follows: 2 marks: for a clear outline of the role of operant conditioning in maintaining a phobia. 1 mark: for a muddled or vague outline of the role of operant conditioning in maintaining a phobia. Possible content • Anxiety reduces as the individual removes themselves from the phobic stimulus/fear inducing situation. • After experiencing this anxiety, the individual will now avoid the phobic stimulus/fear inducing situation so they do not experience the anxiety again (negative reinforcement).	2 AO1 = 2

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
16	Asher has a phobia of horses. Explain how systematic desensitisation could be used to treat Asher's phobia. Possible application • Create a hierarchy of fear/anxiety hierarchy with Asher, eg picture of horse, video of horse, stand next to a field with a horse, stand in the field with the horse, touch the horse with someone holding his head. • Teach Asher relaxation techniques, eg breathing techniques, muscle relaxation exercises. • Gradually expose Asher to each level of his hierarchy, not moving onto the next until Asher is fully relaxed. • Asher could be exposed in real-life (in vivo), eg taken to a stables, or Asher can be asked to use his imagination, (in vitro), eg picture a horse in his mind. Note: If a student describes the process of systematic desensitisation without any reference to Asher's phobia of horses then award a maximum of 1 mark. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Application of systematic desensitisation to Asher's phobia is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Application of systematic desensitisation to Asher's phobia is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Application of systematic desensitisation to Asher's phobia is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Application of systematic desensitisation to Asher's phobia is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO2 = 4
Level	Description	Marks												
2	Application of systematic desensitisation to Asher's phobia is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4												
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Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks												
17	Evaluate systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias. Possible evaluation • Evidence supporting effectiveness of systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias, eg Willis & Edwards (1969). • Levels of anxiety triggered in the patient are lower than alternatives like flooding. This means systematic desensitisation is often considered more acceptable and preferred by patients. • Individuals have to be highly motivated to take part and stay committed to the whole programme (time commitment) for systematic desensitisation to work. Drop-out rates can be high which lowers the overall effectiveness of the treatment. • It is less effective/appropriate for more complex phobias like agoraphobia and social phobias (with a large cognitive element). • Comparison with other therapies, eg CBT, anxiety medications. Credit other relevant material. <table border="1" data-bbox="300 943 1310 1417"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2</td><td>Evaluation of systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>3–4</td></tr> <tr> <td>1</td><td>Evaluation of systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.</td><td>1–2</td></tr> <tr> <td>0</td><td>No creditable content.</td><td>0</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	2	Evaluation of systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias is accurate with some detail. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	3–4	1	Evaluation of systematic desensitisation as a treatment for phobias is limited, vague or muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used.	1–2	0	No creditable content.	0	4 AO3 = 4
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0	No creditable content.	0												

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks						
18	Farah is depressed. She is talking to her mum. Farah says, “I failed my last chemistry test, so I am not doing my chemistry homework this week. I am not clever enough, so I am not going to apply for university.” Her mum replies, “Don’t say that. You did well on your biology test.” Farah says, “The biology result was just luck. Universities only want the best students anyway. Average students like me don’t have a chance.” Use your knowledge of Beck’s negative triad and Ellis’ ABC model to explain Farah’s depression. Beck’s negative triad - Farah demonstrates negative thinking from all three parts of the negative triad: - believing that she is not clever enough shows she has a negative view of herself. - thinking she doesn’t have a chance of getting into university shows a negative view of the future. - thinking that universities only want the best students and wouldn’t want her shows a negative view of the world. - Farah’s negative ways of thinking within the negative triad are resulting in cognitive distortions/biases: - her belief that the biology result was just luck shows minimisation bias by underplaying her strengths. - all of these thoughts stemming from a single chemistry test result shows magnification bias by exaggerating the significance of this one result on her future. - her belief that she is not clever enough is showing overgeneralisation by making a general conclusion about her abilities based on a single subject. Ellis’ ABC model - For Farah the Activating event is failing her chemistry test. - Farah’s irrational Beliefs about failing her chemistry test are that she isn’t clever enough to go to university even though she is doing well in other subjects like biology. She also believes that good results are just luck. - The Consequence of this is that she has become depressed, she is not doing her chemistry homework and she is not applying for university. Note: for level 3 credit both models must be applied. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>Level</th><th>Description</th><th>Marks</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>3</td><td>Application of Beck’s negative triad and Ellis’ ABC model of depression is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.</td><td>5–6</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	Level	Description	Marks	3	Application of Beck’s negative triad and Ellis’ ABC model of depression is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6	6 AO2 = 6
Level	Description	Marks						
3	Application of Beck’s negative triad and Ellis’ ABC model of depression is detailed and appropriate. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology.	5–6						

	2	Application of Beck's negative triad and/or Ellis' ABC model of depression is relevant but detail is lacking. The answer lacks clarity in places. Specialist terminology is occasionally used appropriately. OR one explanation at level 3.	3–4
	1	Application of Beck's negative triad and/or Ellis' ABC model of depression is very limited. The answer is vague/muddled. Specialist terminology is either absent or inappropriately used. OR one explanation at level 2.	1–2
	0	No creditable content.	0

Question	Marking Guidance	Total Marks
19	Depression is often treated using cognitive behaviour therapy (CBT). Explain one limitation of cognitive behaviour therapy as a treatment for depression. Award 3 marks as follows: 3 marks: the explanation of a limitation of cognitive behavioural therapy (CBT) as a treatment for depression is detailed. The answer is clear with appropriate use of specialist terminology. 2 marks: the explanation of a limitation of CBT as a treatment for depression lacks detail. The answer lacks clarity in places. 1 mark: the explanation of a limitation of CBT as a treatment for depression is briefly presented. The answer is very limited/vague/muddled. Possible limitations • There is little evidence that CBT is any more effective than any other forms of psychological therapy. Perhaps it is having someone to talk to that makes the difference rather than the therapy itself, eg Robinson et al (1990). • CBT outcomes can vary with the competence of the therapist, the less skilled the therapist the poorer the patient outcomes, eg Kuyken & Tsivrikos (2009). • CBT is not effective for people with very rigid attitudes and who are resistant to change, or people who have high stress levels due to their life circumstances. • CBT requires a lot of work and motivation on the part of the patient, and for someone with severe depression who is experiencing lethargy and reductions in activity and interest this could be very difficult. Credit other relevant material.	3 AO3 = 3

PS01 grid

	AO1	AO2	AO3	Total
Section A				
01	1			1
02	3			3
03			3	3
04			3	3
05	8	4	8	20
Section B				
06	2			2
07	2			2
08		4		4
09	4			4
10			6	6
11	6		6	12
Section C				
12			3	3
13	6			6
14	2			2
15	2			2
16		4		4
17			4	4
18		6		6
19			3	3
Unit total	36	18	36	90